🔐 Azure Security

80%

of Azure environments struggle with this

RBAC Governance

The enterprise access control challenge

Learn how to prevent privilege sprawl and unauthorized access at scale

👉 Swipe for the solution • 7 slides

Why RBAC becomes difficult to manage

As Azure environments grow, access governance often becomes chaotic.

- Direct user → Owner assignments
- Permanent privileged roles
- RBAC changes done manually in the portal
- No clear separation between teams

Over time this becomes difficult to control.

Why this becomes a real problem

Unstructured RBAC creates serious risks.

- Privilege sprawl across subscriptions
- Difficult access reviews
- Large blast radius for compromised accounts
- No audit trail for RBAC changes

This is where many Azure environments struggle.

Enterprise RBAC governance model

A structured model usually includes:

- Group-based RBAC
- Management Group hierarchy
- Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- Policy guardrails

This creates controlled and auditable access.

Group-based access flow

User

↓

Entra ID Security Group

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RBAC Role Assignment

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Azure Resource Scope

Key rule: No direct user → role assignments

How this can be implemented

Example approach:

- RBAC defined via Terraform
- PIM for privileged platform roles
- Custom roles for CI/CD pipelines
- Azure Policy preventing risky assignments
- RBAC changes reviewed through CI/CD

This creates a controlled governance model.

Reference implementation

I recently built a small reference implementation exploring this model using:

- Terraform
- Azure RBAC
- Privileged Identity Management
- Azure Policy
- CI/CD approval workflows

Project details in the comments. 👇

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💬 What would you implement first in your environment?

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